

Branden Palmer

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Summary

F-16 Crew Chief and Senior Aircraft Technician (2A373) with 11+ years of tactical aircraft maintenance experience. Expertise in leading daily maintenance operations, engine systems, flight control systems, and safety compliance. Successfully embedded with Iraqi Air Force to train technicians to 7-level senior technician status. Achieved engine run qualification and completed F-16 Advanced Crew Chief Certification. NCO Academy and Airman Leadership School graduate.

Experience

F-16 Crew Chief / Senior Aircraft Technician | *Lockheed Martin, Balad AB, Iraq* **2017 - 2020**

- **Crew Chief Operations:** Led daily aircraft maintenance operations, coordinated maintenance activities, and ensured aircraft readiness for deployed missions
- **Engine Systems:** Completed F100 Engine Inlet & Exhaust Inspection training (FEB 2013); achieved engine run qualification during deployment
- **Flight Control Systems:** Performed post-repair flight control weight and balance functions and control surface rigging per designated technical orders and specifications
- **Safety & Tool Control:** Conducted regular Foreign Object Damage (FOD) walks; maintained strict tool control procedures; reported missing, lost, or unattended tools; complied with safety rules and regulations
- **Iraqi Air Force Training:** Embedded with Iraqi Air Force training technicians to upgrade them to 7-level senior technician status
- **Technical Support:** Collaborated with engineering, QA, and production teams to resolve non-conformances and return aircraft to service in deployed operational environments

Military Experience

Tactical Aircraft Maintenance Craftsman | *Air Force, Guard* **2009 - 2017**

- **Pay Grade:** E-6
- **Primary Occupation:** 2A373, Tactical Aircraft Maintenance Craftsman
- **Service Component:** Air Force, Guard

Key Responsibilities:

- **Aircraft Maintenance & Inspection:** Performed end-of-runway, ground handling postflight, preflight, thru-flight, special inspections and phase inspections. Conducted sortie generation operations and hot pit refuels.
- **Engine & Systems Maintenance:** Troubleshooted and maintained aircraft engines, hydraulic, and other related systems, structures, components, and related equipment. Removed and installed aircraft and engine components.
- **Structural Integrity:** Inspected aircraft structures, engines, systems, components, and related systems. Identified and repaired aircraft corrosion for prevention and repair.
- **Maintenance Support Functions:** Performed flight chief, production superintendent, expeditor, crew chief, repair and reclamation, and maintenance support functions.

Training Completed:

- **USAF NCO Academy** (Nov 2015) - 35 Days: Leadership and Management II, Managerial Communications II, Military Studies, Intro to Total Quality Management II
- **CDDAR - Crashed, Damaged, Disabled Aircraft Recovery** (Jan 2015) - 1 Week, 2 Days: Aircraft crash recovery procedures, composite material response and handling
- **Airman Leadership School** (Feb 2014) - 23 Days: Leadership and Management, Managerial Communications, Military Studies, Introduction to Total Quality Management
- **F-16 Advanced Crew Chief Certification** (Mar 2013): Completed F-16 Advanced Crew Chief (Certification Training); held F-16 Maintenance Apprentice designation (Feb 2010, Mar 2010) with comprehensive knowledge of F-16 systems

Education

Community College of The Air Force | *Montgomery, AL, USA* **2009 - 2014**

- A.A.S. in Aviation Maintenance Technology

Technical Skills

- F-16 Aircraft Systems, F100 Engine Systems, Hydraulic Systems
- Flight Control Systems, Weight & Balance, Control Surface Rigging
- Aircraft Inspection, Maintenance Documentation, Quality Assurance
- Safety Procedures (FOD Prevention), Tool Control, Safety Compliance